

Age-Appropriate Baby Sleep & Nap Schedule

Recent expert guidelines agree that newborns sleep ~16–17 h/day (irregularly) and gradually consolidate sleep by age 2. For example, the American Academy of Sleep Medicine (AAP) recommends **14–17 h/24h** for 0–3 months, **12–15 h** for 4–11 months, and **11–14 h** for 1–2 years ¹. SleepFoundation likewise notes newborns typically sleep 16–18 h and infants 12–16 h per day (including naps) ² ¹.

Wake windows: Babies' maximum wake times ("wake windows") lengthen with age. Cleveland Clinic's pediatrics group advises about **0.5–1.0 h** wake for 0–1 mo, **1.0–2.0 h** for 1–3 mo, **1.25–2.5 h** for 3–4 mo, **2–4 h** for 5–7 mo, **2.5–4.5 h** for 7–10 mo, and **3–6 h** by 10–12 mo ³. In contrast, a Weissbluth-based pediatrics summary suggests slightly shorter windows: ~45–60 min (0–6 wk), 60–90 min (6–12 wk), 75–120 min (3–4 mo), 2–2.5 h (5–6 mo), 2.5–3.5 h (7–9 mo), 3–4 h (10–12 mo), and 4–5 h (12–18 mo) ⁴. In practice, apps should err on the shorter side of these ranges to avoid overtiredness. We combine these into our table (below) as ranges with a typical midpoint; e.g. by 9–12 mo we use ~3.0–4.0 h (midpoint ~3.5 h), roughly the conservative end of expert ranges ⁵ ⁶.

Naps and daytime sleep: After the newborn period, infants generally take multiple naps per day. Newborns (~0–4 wk) often have 5–6 naps (sleep periods) per 24 h, while 2–3 mo infants usually nap ~4–5 times daily. By 4–6 mo many babies settle into about 3–4 naps per day (total day sleep ~3.5–5 h), and by 6–9 mo often 2–3 naps (day ~2.5–4 h) ⁷ ⁸. Around 9–12 mo most are on a **two-nap** schedule, totaling ~2–3 h daytime sleep. By 12–18 mo many transition to 1–2 naps (often consolidating toward one), and by 18–24 mo typically take just one nap of about 1–3 h (total day sleep ~1–3 h) ⁹ ¹⁰. We note the AASM/AAP review that "infants typically sleep 9–12 h during the night and take 30 min to 2-hour naps, one to four times a day – fewer as they reach age one" ⁷. That source implies naps of roughly 0.5–2 h each and matches the table ranges below.

Night sleep and bedtime: Night sleep correspondingly increases with age. Most infants get ~9–12 h of night sleep by 4–12 mo ⁷, and toddlers ~10–12 h at night (given total 11–14 h/24h). Pediatric experts also emphasize **early bedtimes**: Weissbluth and others advise putting babies down around **6–8 pm** ¹¹. In practice, many infants by 3–6 mo have a bedtime ~7–8 pm, and toddlers do best around **7–8 pm** ¹¹ ¹². (Studies show toddler bedtimes before 9 pm yield better sleep outcomes ¹².)

Below is a summary table of recommended wake windows, naps, sleep durations, and bedtimes by age bracket. Each cell gives the typical **range (with midpoint)** based on the sources above. Discrepancies are noted: for example, Cleveland Clinic allows up to ~6 h awake by 10–12 mo ⁵, but Weissbluth's conservative schedule uses ~3–4 h ⁶ – here we take the shorter values to be safe. Where available we cite AAP/medical sources for each metric.

Age (mo)	Wake (h)	Naps/day	Nap length (h)	Daytime (h)	Night (h)	Total (h)	Bedtime
0–1	0.5–1.0 (0.75) ³	5–6	0.5–2.0 (1.0)	6–8 (7)	8–10 (9) ⁸	14–17 (16) ¹	7:00–8:00 pm ¹¹

Age (mo)	Wake (h)	Naps/day	Nap length (h)	Daytime (h)	Night (h)	Total (h)	Bedtime
1-2	1.0-2.0 (1.5) ³	5-6	0.5-2.0 (1.0)	5-7 (6)	9-11 (10)	14-17 (16) ¹	7:00-8:00 pm ¹¹
2-3	1.0-2.0 (1.5) ³	4-5	0.5-2.0 (1.0)	5-6 (5.5)	9-11 (10)	14-17 (16) ¹	7:00-8:00 pm ¹¹
3-4	1.25-2.5 (1.9) ⁵	4-5	0.5-2.0 (1.0)	5-6 (5.5)	10-11 (10.5)	14-17 (16) ¹	6:30-7:30 pm ¹¹
4-6	2.0-3.0 (2.5) ¹³	3-4 ⁷	0.5-2.0 (1.25) ⁷	3.5-5.0 (4.25)	9-12 (10.5) ⁷	12-15 (13.5) ¹	6:30-8:00 pm ¹¹
6-9	2.5-3.5 (3.0) ¹⁴	2-3 ⁷	1.0-2.0 (1.5) ⁷	2.5-4.0 (3.25)	10-12 (11) ⁷	12-15 (13.5) ¹	6:30-7:30 pm ¹¹
9-12	3.0-4.0 (3.5) ⁶	2 ⁷	1.0-2.0 (1.5) ⁷	2.0-3.0 (2.5)	11-12 (11.5) ⁷	12-15 (13.5) ¹	6:30-7:30 pm ¹¹
12-18	4.0-5.0 (4.5) ¹⁵	1-2 ⁹	1.0-3.0 (2.0)	1.0-3.0 (2.0)	10-12 (11)	11-14 (12.5) ¹	7:00-8:00 pm ¹²
18-24	4.0-6.0 (5.0)	1 ⁹	1.0-3.0 (2.0)	1.0-3.0 (2.0)	10-12 (11)	11-14 (12.5) ¹	7:00-8:00 pm ¹²

Sources: American Academy of Pediatrics and Sleep Society recommendations ¹ ; Cleveland Clinic (Dr. Barrett) on wake windows ³ ; Mayo Clinic parenting (citing AAP) on nap patterns ⁸ ; pediatric sleep guides (Weissbluth) ⁴ ; Taking Cara Babies (toddler bedtime) ¹² . Discrepancies are noted above (we used the more conservative values when experts differed). All times are approximate ranges.

¹ ⁷ ⁹ Microsoft Word - New Sleep Recommendations handout 9Feb2015

https://www.paaap.org/uploads/1/2/4/3/124369935/551b74_0a25804f79b44994bb8db7ed9ed957db.pdf

² How Much Sleep Do Babies and Kids Need?

<https://www.sleepfoundation.org/children-and-sleep/how-much-sleep-do-kids-need>

³ ⁵ Wake Windows by Age

<https://health.clevelandclinic.org/wake-windows-by-age>

⁴ ⁶ ¹¹ ¹³ ¹⁴ ¹⁵ From Newborn to Toddler: Setting the Stage for Healthy Sleep - The Pediatric Care Center and The Teen And Young Adult Care Center

<https://thepediatriccarecenter.com/from-newborn-to-toddler-setting-the-stage-for-healthy-sleep/>

⁸ Baby naps: Daytime sleep tips - Mayo Clinic

<https://www.mayoclinic.org/healthy-lifestyle/infant-and-toddler-health/in-depth/baby-naps/art-20047421>

10 **Baby sleep schedule by age: Nap and sleep chart | Huckleberry**

<https://huckleberrycare.com/blog/baby-sleep-schedule-by-age-nap-and-sleep-chart>

12 **Toddler Bedtime Routine with Printable Chart | Taking Cara Babies**

<https://www.takingcarababies.com/blogs/toddlers/toddler-bedtime-routine-with-printable-chart?srltid=AfmBOoqm0TpkPGIjUW3AJ0BPqCuhoBOIVRvcMzjal1e8F2G5qaiGbbqe>